

Cancel complain culture

THE INTERNET HAS TURNED A LOT OF US INTO MOLLY-CODDLED, PRIVILEGED BABIES WHO COMPLAIN A LOT.

In fact, as someone who lives in Australia, which is considered the “developed world”, or “first world” or whatever other term you want to use to describe it, I am often made aware of the privilege I take for granted. When I complain about not getting parking close to a mall entrance, or my coffee not being hot enough, my very grounded-in-reality wife is quick to remind me about what a whiny, entitled baby I’m becoming.

We’re all pretty used to cancel-culture, put downs, pwnage, mic drops and the like, because social media has reduced interactions into the college life depicted in 80s Hollywood movies – where all that matters is one-upmanship. Or maybe social media isn’t the cause, but merely the mirror that shows us how shallow and empty we really are... Whatever the reason, the world as a whole is now pretty adept at dragging everyone else down, especially for every little faux pas committed, and we are now expert complainers. Heck, the irony is, I’m sitting here essentially complaining about complaining, which is a mark of how much complain culture has taken over. Still, I’m hoping this rant will actually end with something positive for a change, and that you will be much more positive than I usually am.

Over the past few months we have received a lot of complaints about our content. If we reviewed a Chinese product, we got complaints about that. If we wrote about Indian brands, we got complaints that ridiculed such an idea in a globalised world. Then we started getting hundreds of messages from Pakistanis, seeking more information about a phone called “Digit”, which was launched by some company there. We even got complaints from Indians about the Digit phone being sold in Pakistan! Add all this confusion on top of a very large pile of people asking us about COVID-19 insurance because they think we’re behind the relatively new insurance company called Digit (we aren’t), and it’s strange times for us indeed.

Why is it that we can rally around a negative event, but will not do that for positive news. In fact, is there even such a thing as positive news any more?

Our cover story this month is an attempt to step away from this constant negativity. Instead of being hysterical about what’s wrong with the world, and then doing nothing about it ourselves, we want to try and actually make a difference. You will read more in the cover story itself about how we hope to do that, and how we have found very worthy allies, however, for this column I just want to focus on the need to change our individual perspective.

It’s easy to complain about the lack of truly Indian products in various verticals, but complaining about an outcome will never change it. It’s time we all rolled up our collective sleeves and did something to change the outcome by focusing on the start... or in this case, the startups.

Instead of complaining about why there are no Indian companies that do XYZ, we’re hoping you will now start following and supporting the Indian startups that #IndiaProject will highlight.

We’re certainly going to try and do our bit, and we sincerely hope you will help us along the way, because success or failure lies in your hands. All you really have to do is click on #IndiaProject advertisements you see on digit.in, or visit the URLs of ads you see in this magazine. You can share a social post we make about startups, or forward them via messaging apps to those you think would be interested.

Supporting Indian startups will cost you nothing more than a few minutes of your time, but it can make a huge difference to them and their products, as it will help them reach those looking for Indian solutions and products that they’re offering. Surely we can all contribute a few minutes of our time towards achieving this?

I’ll be honest, when our publishing director came up with this brilliant idea (which will actually cause losses for the company), many people we took this idea to were skeptical. Not because they didn’t like the idea of supporting Indian companies, but because they just didn’t think members of the general public would contribute even a few minutes towards the goal.

I sincerely hope each and every one of you reading this proves the all the skeptics wrong. Show them that when the cause is worthy enough, we can all get together and cancel complain culture. 🇮🇳



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